



# ShabbaTTogether

## Teen Talks with Coping Skills Tools



### Goals:

To provide teens with a safe environment to discuss stressful situations and hand out that provide coping skills tools.

### Target Audience:

Teens

### Time:

Approximately 1 hour

### Medium:

Facilitated Program. Virtual or In-person.

### Note to Facilitator:

- Ideally, Teen Talks are facilitated by the teens themselves.
- Adults and other youth leaders are only present to help manage the group as well as follow-up with any teen who shares something concerning.
- This program includes the Teen Talks Program outline (pg. 1-4) and three additional handouts to be used during the program or sent home with teen participants if you choose. They are:
  - Shalom Zone (pg. 5-6)
  - Coping Skills BINGO and Worksheet (pg. 7)

## Teen Talks Program

A guide to facilitating conversations between teens about important topics surrounding mental health.

### Purpose:

- The purpose of Teen Talks is to create a safe environment where young people feel comfortable discussing their mental health and other important topics.
- In many spaces, there is a stigma around discussing mental health. It is often thought of as something that should never be discussed and certainly not with your peers.
- Teen Talks is intended to help smash that stigma. It is a space where everyone is encouraged to share their experience, listen attentively to others, offer support, and build relationships.
- Typically, each Teen Talk is focused around a different Teen-related theme as seen below.

### Planning:

1. Choose the date and time for the Teen Talk. You should plan for at least a 1 hour conversation.
2. Identify a topic for the Teen Talk. Some examples include:
  - Stress
  - Coping Skills
  - Positive thinking
  - School (virtual during pandemic)
  - One Thing I Wish my Parents Knew
  - Family
  - Exams
  - Siblings
  - Pick their own...
3. Adult Facilitator - Based on the topics the teens choose, determine whether the [Shalom Zone](#) handout or [Coping Skills BINGO](#) and [Worksheet](#) are appropriate.
4. Identify one or two youth to serve as the Teen Talk facilitators.
5. The Teen Talk facilitators should work together to create discussion questions around the chosen topic.
  - It is important to allow the facilitators to create the questions on their own. Have them send you the questions to review beforehand so you can make any adjustments together.
  - Facilitators should bring a copy of their questions to the Teen Talk.

6. They can also prepare an ice breaker to use the day of the event.
  - [In-Person ice breakers](#)
  - [Virtual ice breakers](#)
7. Advertise your Teen Talk. Each Teen Talk should have no more than 10-15 teens. If you recruit more than that, we recommend you split the group into multiple smaller groups.

### Implementation and Agenda:

On the day of your scheduled Teen Talk, we suggest you stick to the following agenda:

### Welcome and Group Guidelines

- Welcome everyone and give them an overview of Teen Talks. For example, you could say:
  - *Hi everyone! Welcome to Teen Talks. Today we are going to be having a discussion around the topic of [\_\_\_\_\_]. Teen Talks are a safe space for you all to talk with and support one another. I am just here to help, if need be. Before we get started, I want to share a couple ground rules with you all so that this space feels safe for everyone.*
- We suggest you implement the following **rules** in your Teen Talk group (plus, any rules you would like to add).
  - The details that are shared here stay here. General information of course can be shared! Like what you liked about this, learned from it, etc.
  - Be aware of language. Do not use stereotypes or use demeaning language.
  - Ask and encourage questions!
  - Always assume the best and most genuine intention of others.
  - No interrupting.
  - If you feel like you need a break, feel free to excuse yourself and come back when you have regrouped.
  - If you notice that you're the person who is doing the most talking, give someone else a chance to join the conversation.
  - Ask the group: What else are we missing?
  - **Recommended:** Always mention to keep phones away to limit distractions.

### Introductions with an Ice Breaker:

- Ask everyone to go around and say their name as well as their answer to the ice breaker question.

### Discussion:

- Have the facilitators lead the discussion using the questions they prepared.
- As the adult, you can be available to get the conversation back on topic if it goes off track.
- As the adult, be mindful of who comes without friends and try to engage them in conversation/small talk before and after Teen Talks.
- As the adult, you should also be listening for things that come up that require checking in with the teen after the conversation (i.e suicidal ideation).

### Closing

- When the discussion comes to an end, thank everyone for coming.
- Remind them about the ground rules about confidentiality you shared at the beginning of the Teen Talk.

### Follow-up:

- Be sure to follow-up with any teens that shared anything concerning and/or expressed the need for further help.
- **Recommended:** Have a mental health professional that you trust to turn to with questions that arise or concerns you may have after your Teen Talks. It is always best to proactively approach any situation that may arise by asking questions before something escalates.



# ShabbaTTogether

## Shalom Zone Guide for Teens

**Goal:** To create a quiet/calm down space in your home for you to use to help regulate strong emotions in a healthy way.

**Target Audience:** Teens ages 13-18

**Time:** Approximately 1 hour to create or more if you want to be creative

**Medium:** @Home project

**Note:**

You are presented with tons of new experiences and expectations all the time. It can be hard to have a lot of expectations placed on you at school and not feel stressed at times. Life can sometimes feel overwhelming and it can be helpful to have a quiet place to unwind.

### What is a Shalom Zone?

Sometimes winding down can be hard, especially with all of the distractions around like school, friends, parents, siblings, TV, internet, etc. Creating a quiet corner or a reading nook can give you a wonderful opportunity to find calm.

The Shalom Zone can be your safe space to go when you need help calming your body, taking a brain break, want to get a handle on your emotions, or just need some alone time. It is meant to be a place for you to relax, recharge, or even release your pent-up anger or frustration.

## Picking The Right Space For The Shalom Zone

Talk to your parent and see if they have any ideas for where and how you could make a quiet space. Then work with your parent to try to pick one space in your house or apartment for your Shalom Zone area so that you can have one designated space. It should be away from distractions and can be really anywhere you want: in your bedroom, in the basement, under the stairs, in a closet, in a corner of a room — wherever you think you will be the most comfortable!

## When To Use The Shalom Zone

The Shalom Zone space should feel welcoming and inviting to you. This is not a place for you to feel punished or isolated, rather a special place that you can feel safe to work out emotions, take a break and/or calm yourself down.

You can use the Shalom Zone right after school or before bed to help unwind and decompress after a long day. You can also use it when you feel frustrated, sad, angry, or any time your emotions feel intense.

## What To Include In Your Shalom Zone

Do you have some comforting things that would make a calm space for you? If you are feeling really creative you can check out Pinterest or check out *Quiet Spaces* online for ideas that use things around the house to make a cool area. You can also visit a thrift store, Dollar Store, or Amazon if you want to decorate your space.

It can also be helpful to consider having a poster with reminders on how you like to calm down, calming stretches or exercises, motivational phrases or pictures, or different emotions you may be feeling. This is not a space to be on your phone with friends, or play video games - as tempting as it may be. This is a space to take time to reduce distractions and sensory input and focus on those that can calm you outside of technology.

- Here are some examples of items to consider including in your Shalom Zone: ● Printable Signs to Hang:
  - ○ A [“My Shalom Zone”](#) sign that your child designs and can hang in their space
  - ○ Emotional Regulation Chart - [What Zone Am I In?](#)
  - ○ [10 Steps to Calm Down](#)
  - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Exercises](#)
  - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Motivational Phrases](#)
  - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Emotions](#)
- A comfy place to sit like a bean bag chair, some pillows, or big chair
- A journal to document your journey or get out your emotions
- A sketchbook to express your feelings or relax through art
- Lego, playdough/clay, or some fun toy that you may still like to play with
- [Fidget toys to spin, twist and manipulate](#)
- Art supplies and/or sticker books
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Puzzles
- [One Person card games](#)
- Noise-reducing headphones to block out sounds that are overwhelming
- [Chewy jewelry and toys](#)
- Stress balls to squeeze or [make your own!](#)
- A favorite stuffed animal to hug
- [Something visual like a sensory bottle, kaleidoscope or lava lamp](#) or [make your own!](#)
- Engaging one-person activities like activity books, individual board games, building blocks, drawing books or magnet tiles.



## ShabbaTTogether@Home Coping Skills Bingo Game and Worksheet

**Goals:** Show your family members of all ages different things they can do to cope with how they are feeling or with strong emotions.

**Target Audience:** Ages 5 to young adult

**Time:** Approximately 25 minutes

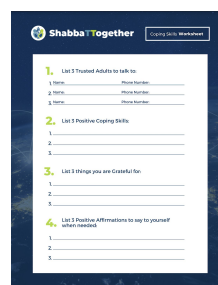
**Medium:** In person for ShabbaTTogether@Home

### Directions:

1. Discuss situations which might cause your family members to worry - e.g. changes in their lives, start of school, change in schedule, online school, new move, new sibling, divorce, etc.
2. Discuss what they could do if they are feeling strong emotions.
3. Give a BINGO card to every family member.
4. Play BINGO as usual by reading out the coping skills and let the children mark them off
5. Decide the rules of winning the game: the first child to fill a row in any direction or full card wins.
6. Finish BINGO with an upbeat identification of things you can now do to be positive and manage difficult feelings. Remind your children that this is not the same as ignoring difficult feelings or pretending not to have them, and that feelings are neither right nor wrong.
7. After the conclusion of the BINGO game, give each child a Coping Skills Worksheet. Explain they can use the BINGO as a guide to complete the worksheet. When finished, children can hang the Worksheet in a helpful location so it can help them when they feel they need it.



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Bingo](#)



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